

Jennifer L. Crawford

Center for Vital Longevity
University of Texas at Dallas
1600 Viceroy Dr, Suite 800
Dallas, TX 75235

Email: jennifer.crawford@utdallas.edu
Web: jlcrawford.netlify.app
Bluesky: jlcrawford.bsky.social
Code: github.com/jlcrawford

Current Position

Assistant Professor, Department of Psychology, University of Texas at Dallas	2026-present
Director, Motivated Cognition and Healthy Aging Lab	

Education

Ph.D., Psychological & Brain Sciences, Washington University	2022
M.A., Psychological & Brain Sciences, Washington University	2019
B.S., Neuroscience, Brandeis University (<i>Highest Honors</i>)	2015

Previous Positions

Postdoctoral Fellow, Brandeis University (Mentor: Anne Berry)	2023-2026
Graduate Student, Washington University (Mentor: Todd Braver)	2017-2022
Research Assistant, Yale University (Mentor: Gregory Samanez-Larkin)	2015-2017
Undergraduate Research Assistant, Brandeis University (Mentor: Angela Gutchess)	2012-2015

Awards & Honors

Butler-Williams Scholar, National Institute on Aging	2026
Neuroeconomics Summer School, Fellow	2025
Individual Postdoctoral Training Fellowship (F32-AG085890)	2024-2026
Postdoctoral Neuroscience Training Fellowship (T32-NS007292)	2023-2024
Dean's Award for Graduate Research Excellence (WUSTL)	2022
Kavli Summer Institute in Cognitive Neuroscience, Fellow	2022
Dissertation Research Award (WUSTL Psychological & Brain Sciences)	2021
Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award (WUSTL Psychological & Brain Sciences)	2021
Cognitive, Computational, & Systems Neuroscience Training Fellowship (T32-NS115672)	2021-2022
Summer School in Social Neuroscience and Neuroeconomics, Fellow	2019
Sallie P. Asche Travel Award, Dallas Aging & Cognition Conference	2019, 2023
Aging & Development Training Fellowship (T32-AG000030)	2018-2021
Provost's Undergraduate Research Fund Summer Research Fellowship	2014
Joel Friedland '76 Endowed Scholarship	2014

Research Support

NIA/NIH – R21-AG086729, Berry (PI)
Aging, activity diversity, and brain health.
Dates: 5/1/2024–4/30/2026; Direct Costs: \$275,000
Role: Postdoc (co-wrote grant)

NIA/NIH – R24-AG054355, Scientific Research Network on Decision Neuroscience and Aging
Cognitive effort and aging: Pilot project.
Dates: 6/1/2019–3/31/2022; Direct Costs: \$30,000
Role: PI (subaward)

Publications

- Crawford, J.L.**, Adornato, A., Matulonis, J., Chen, X., Hooker, J.M., & Berry, A.S. (2026). Dissociable mechanisms underlie differences between memory and metamemory in older adults: The Differentiating role of anxiety and depression symptoms. *Hippocampus*, 36(3), e70100.
- Crawford, J.L.**, Chen, H-Y., Adornato, A., Matulonis, J., Hooker, J.M., Jacobs, H.I.L., & Berry, A.S. (2026). Late life brain structure in the cingulate cortex and locus coeruleus is associated with engagement in complex mental activities across the life span. *Neurobiology of Aging*, 167, 120-128.
- Morin, T.M., Cowan, J.L., Chen, H-Y., Parent, J., **Crawford, J.L.**, Ciampa, C.J., Shah, V.D., Whitman, A.J., Swinneton, K.N., Hsu, M., Jagust, W.J., & Berry, A.S. (2026). Dopamine-driven memory effects in healthy aging are disrupted by preclinical Alzheimer's disease. *Journal of Neuroscience*, 46(7), e1580252026.
- Chen, H-Y., Gold, B.S., Ciampa, C.J., **Crawford, J.L.**, Adornato, A.A., Cowan, J.L., O'Malley, K.E., Snyder, H.R., & Berry, A.S. (2025). Understanding the cognitive factors which contribute to individual differences in financial capacity in aging. *Scientific Reports*, 15, 15398.
- Crawford, J.L.** & Berry, A.S. (2024). Examining resilience to Alzheimer's disease through the lens of monoaminergic neuromodulator systems. *Trends in Neurosciences*, 47(11), 892-903.
- Crawford, J.L.**, Brough, R.E., Eisenstein, S.A., Peelle, J.E., & Braver, T.S. (2024). Generalized encoding of the relative subjective value of cognitive effort in dorsal ACC. *Journal of Neuroscience*, 44(38), 1-14.
Selected as featured article by Editor.
- Aschenbrenner, A.J. **Crawford, J.L.**, Peelle, J.E., Fagan, A.M., Benzinger, T.L.S., Morris, J.C., Hassenstab, J., & Braver, T.S. (2023). Increased cognitive effort costs in healthy aging and preclinical Alzheimer's disease. *Psychology and Aging*, 38(5), 428-442. ***Selected as featured article by Editor.***
- Crawford, J.L.**, English, T., & Braver, T.S. (2023). Cognitive effort-based decision-making across experimental and daily life indices in younger and older adults. *Journal of Gerontology: Psychological Sciences*, 78(1), 40-50.
- Green, M.A., **Crawford, J.L.**, Kuhnen, C.M., Samanez-Larkin, G.R., & Seaman, K.L. (2023). Multivariate associations between dopamine receptor availability and risky investment decision making across adulthood. *Cerebral Cortex Communications*, 4(2), tgad008.
- Crawford, J. L.**, Eisenstein, S. A., Peelle, J. E. & Braver, T. S. (2022). Domain-general cognitive motivation: Evidence from economic decision-making – Final Registered Report. *Cognitive Research: Principles and Implications*, 7(1), 23.
- Crawford, J.L.**, English, T., & Braver, T.S. (2022). Incorporating Ecological Momentary Assessment into multimethod investigations of cognitive aging: Promise and practical considerations. *Psychology and Aging*, 37(1), 84–96.
- Yee, D. M., **Crawford, J. L.** & Braver, T. S. (2022). An fMRI protocol for administering liquid incentives to human participants. *Star Protocols*, 3(4), 101707.

Yee, D.M., **Crawford, J.L.**, Lamichhane, B., & Braver, T.S. (2021). Dorsal anterior cingulate cortex encodes the subjective motivational value of cognitive task performance. *Journal of Neuroscience*, 41(16), 3707-3720.

Crawford, J.L., Yee, D.M., Hallenbeck, H.W., Naumann, A., Shapiro, K., Thompson, R.J., & Braver, T.S. (2020). Dissociable effects of monetary, liquid, and social incentives on motivation and cognitive control. *Frontiers in Cognition*, 11, 2212.

Castrellon, J. J., Seaman, K. L., **Crawford, J. L.**, Young, J. S., Smith, C. T., Dang, L. C., et al. (2019). Individual differences in dopamine are associated with reward discounting in clinical groups but not in healthy adults. *Journal of Neuroscience*, 39(2), 321.

Juarez, E.J., Castrellon, J.J., Green, M.A., **Crawford, J.L.**, Seaman, K.L., Smith, C.T., Dang, L.C., Zald, D.H., & Samanez-Larkin, G.R. (2019). Reproducibility of the correlative triad among aging, dopamine receptor availability, and cognition. *Psychology and Aging*, 34(7), 921–932.

Smith, C.T., **Crawford, J.L.**, Dang, L.C., Seaman, K.L., San Juan, M.D., Vijay, A., Katz, D.T., Matuskey, D., Cowan, R.L., Morris, E.D., Zald, D.H., & Samanez-Larkin, G.R. (2019). Partial volume correction increases estimated dopamine D2-like receptor binding potential and reduces adult age differences. *Journal of Cerebral Blood Flow & Metabolism*, 39(5), 822–833.

Book Chapters

Crawford, J.L. & Braver, T.S. (2026). Cognitive effort engagement across the adult life span. In Elliot, A.J. (Ed.) *Advances in Motivation Science*. Elsevier.

Manuscripts Under Review/In Revision

Crawford, J.L., Brough, R.E., Eisenstein, S.A., Peelle, J.E., & Braver, T.S. Caudate dopamine predicts cognitive effort decisions both in the lab and daily life.

Crawford, J.L., Matulonis, J., Lewis, M., Chen, H-Y., Jacobs, H.I.L., Heller, A.S., & Berry, A.S. Affective benefits of daily life activity and experiential diversity are associated with catecholamine systems across the adult life span.

Kiyemba, D.M., Chen, H-Y., **Crawford, J.L.**, Adornato, A.A., Matulonis, J., Lewis, M., & Berry, A.S. Convergent validity of movie-based and traditional episodic memory tasks: Implications for detecting depressive and anxiety symptoms in aging.

Wei, M., **Crawford, J.L.**, Etzel, J.A., English, T., Thompson, R.J., & Braver, T.S. Common and distinct effects of age and depression on cognitive effort-based decision-making.

Yee, D.M. & **Crawford, J.L.** Affect and motivation: Mechanisms across the life span.

Manuscripts In Prep

Crawford, J.L., English, T., & Braver, T.S. Within- and between-person associations of daily life affect and mentally demanding activity participation in younger and older adults.

Crawford, J.L., Matulonis, J., Carlson, E.L., Chen, H-Y., Jacobs, H.I.L., & Berry, A.S. Dissociable effects of age, apathy and depression symptoms, and locus coeruleus integrity on cognitive effort-based decision-making.

Invited Talks

Crawford, J.L. (2026). Aging and the costs of cognitive effort. Center for Vital Longevity, UT Dallas.

Crawford, J.L., et al. (2026). Coupling between daily life diversity and positive affect is associated with catecholaminergic integrity across the adult life span. Social and Affective Neuroscience Society Annual Meeting, San Diego, CA.

Crawford, J.L. (2026). Cognition, affect, and motivation across the adult life span: through the lens of the lab and daily life. Center for Vital Longevity, UT Dallas.

Crawford, J.L., et al. (2025). Dissociable effects of age, apathy and depression symptoms, and locus coeruleus integrity on cognitive effort-based decision-making. Society for Neuroeconomics Annual Meeting, Boston, MA.

Crawford, J.L. (2023). Neural mechanisms of cognitive effort-based decision-making: a multimethod approach. Cognitive Neuroscience Society Conference Data Blitz, San Francisco, CA.

Crawford, J.L. (2022). Aging and the costs of cognitive effort. Aging Well Lab, UT Dallas.

Crawford, J.L. & Braver, T.S. (2021). Domain general cognitive motivation and economic decision-making: A registered report. A Bunch of Control Datablitzes (ABCD) (virtual).

Crawford, J.L. & Braver, T.S. (2020). Aging and the costs of cognitive effort. Scientific Research Network on Decision Neuroscience & Aging Conference, Honolulu, HI.

Local

Crawford, J.L. (2024). Influence of Alzheimer's disease pathology and anxiety and depressive symptoms on memory and metamemory in older adults. Postdoctoral Neuroscience Research Symposium, Brandeis.

Crawford, J.L. (2023). Aging and the costs of cognitive effort. Postdoctoral Neuroscience Research Symposium, Brandeis University.

Crawford, J.L. & Braver, T.S. (2022). Does the cost of cognitive effort differ among younger and older adults? A multimethod approach. Cognitive, Computational, and Systems Neuroscience Annual Retreat.

Crawford, J.L., English, T. & Braver, T.S. (2022). Examining cognitive effort costs across experimental and daily life indices in younger and older adults. Washington University Aging & Development Brown Bag.

Poster Presentations

Crawford, J.L., Matulonis, J., Lewis, M., Adornato, A., & Berry, A.S. (2026). Effects of daily diversity on learning and memory are moderated by cortical thickness and tau burden. Organization for Human Brain Mapping Annual Meeting, Bordeaux, France.

Crawford, J.L., Matulonis, J., Lewis, M., Chen, H-Y., Jacobs, H.I.L., Heller, A.S., & Berry, A.S. (2026). Coupling between daily life diversity and positive affect is associated with catecholaminergic integrity across the adult life span. Social and Affective Neuroscience Society Annual Meeting, San Diego, CA.

Marcus, R.E., Costello, M.S., Chen, H-Y., **Crawford, J.L.**, McClay, M., Clewett, D.V., & Berry, A.S. (2026). Age-

related differences in the perception of musically induced emotions and episodic memory performance. Social and Affective Neuroscience Society Annual Meeting, San Diego, CA.

Crawford, J.L., Matulonis, J., Carlson, E.L., Chen, H-Y., Jacobs, H.I.L., & Berry, A.S. (2025). Dissociable effects of age, apathy and depression symptoms, and locus coeruleus integrity on cognitive effort-based decision-making. Society for Neuroeconomics Annual Meeting, Boston, MA.

Marcus, R.E., Costello, M.S., Chen, H-Y., **Crawford, J.L.**, McClay, M., Clewett, D.V., & Berry, A.S. (2025). Establishing the influence of music-induced emotions on temporal memory structure in aging. Dallas Aging & Cognition Conference, Dallas, TX.

Morin, T.M., Ciampa, C.J., Chen, H-Y., **Crawford, J.L.**, Parent, J., Adornato, A., Cowan, J.L., O'Malley, K., Cusin, C., Hsu, M., Hooker, J.M., Jagust, W.J., & Berry, A.S. (2025). Effects of dopamine and amyloid-beta on rest-to-task network configuration in older adults. Organization for Human Brain Mapping Conference, Brisbane, Australia.

Crawford, J.L., Adornato, A., Matulonis, J., Hooker, J.M., & Berry, A.S. (2024). Influence of tau pathology and anxiety and depressive symptoms on metamemory in cognitively normal older adults. Alzheimer's Association International Conference, Philadelphia, PA.

Wei, M., Etzel, J.A., **Crawford, J.L.**, English, T., Thompson, R.J., & Braver, T.S. (2024). Dissociable effects of age and major depressive disorder on neural mechanisms of cognitive effort-based decision-making. Society for the Science of Motivation Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA.

Wei, M., Etzel, J.A., **Crawford, J.L.**, Thompson, R.J., English, T., & Braver, T.S. (2024). Neural correlates of reward evaluation in relation to Major Depressive Disorder. Anxiety and Depression Association of America Annual Conference, Boston, MA.

Crawford, J.L., Brough, R.E., Eisenstein, S.A., English, T., Peelle, J.E., & Braver, T.S. (2023). Does the cost of cognitive effort differ among younger and older adults? A multimethod approach. Dallas Aging & Cognition Conference, Dallas, TX.

Crawford, J.L., Brough, R.E., Eisenstein, S.A., Peelle, J.E., & Braver, T.S. (2023). Neural mechanisms of cognitive effort-based decision-making: a multimethod approach. Cognitive Neuroscience Society Conference, San Francisco, CA.

Castrellon, J.J., **Crawford, J.L.**, Hsu, M., & Samanez-Larkin, G.R. (2022). Individual differences in extrastriatal D2-like receptors shape strategic social learning. Society for Neuroeconomics Annual Meeting, Arlington, VA.

Crawford, J.L., English, T. & Braver, T.S. (2022). Effects of gain and loss incentive framing on cognitive effort-based decision-making in younger and older adults: A multimethod approach. Cognitive Aging Conference, Atlanta, GA.

Crawford, J.L., English, T. & Braver, T.S. (2021). Combining experimental and daily life sampling approaches in aging research: opportunities and challenges. Society for Ambulatory Assessment Conference (virtual).

Crawford, J.L., Yee, D.M., Lamichhane, B., Di Rosa, E., & Braver, T.S. (2020). Neural Mechanisms of Motivated Cognitive Control in Older Adults. Organization for Human Brain Mapping Conference (virtual).

Moore, I.L., Fields, E.C., **Crawford, J.L.**, Paige, L.E., Cassidy, B.S., & Gutchess, A. (2020). Attentional Prioritization of Negative Appearance-Behavior Cues in Impression Formation. Cognitive Neuroscience Society Conference, Boston, MA (virtual).

Crawford, J.L., Yee, D.M., & Braver, T.S. (2019). Age-related changes in motivational integration involving socio-emotional incentives. Dallas Aging & Cognition Conference, Dallas, TX.

Johnson, C.P., Castrellon, J.J., **Crawford, J.L.**, & Samanez-Larkin, G.R. (2019). I like it like that: reward discounting and appetitive responses to amphetamine in a drug naïve sample of healthy adults. Interdisciplinary Symposium on Decision Neuroscience, Durham NC.

Juarez, E.J., Castrellon, J.J., **Crawford, J.L.**, Green, M.A., McAllister, G.A., Seaman, K.L., Smith, C.T., Dang, L.C., Zald, D.H., & Samanez-Larkin, G.R. (2018). Reliability of the correlative triad among aging, dopamine, and cognition. Cognitive Neuroscience Society Conference, Boston, MA & Cognitive Aging Conference, Atlanta, GA.

Crawford, J.L., Seaman, K.L., Vijay, A., Matuskey, D., Morris, E.D., & Samanez-Larkin, G.R. (2017). Effects of age on extrastriatal dopamine D2 receptor availability are overestimated without partial volume correction. Dallas Aging and Cognition Conference, Dallas, TX & Cognitive Neuroscience Society Conference, San Francisco, CA.

McAllister, G.A., Castrellon, J.J., Seaman, K.L., **Crawford, J.L.**, Blow, T., Smith, C.T., Dang, L.C., Hsu, M., Zald, D.H., & Samanez-Larkin, G.R. (2017). Individual differences in dopamine receptor availability are not associated with preferences for time, probability, or effort across adulthood. Society for Neuroeconomics Annual Meeting, Toronto, Canada.

Zhang, Z., Saez, I., **Crawford, J.L.**, Seaman, K.L., Samanez-Larkin, G.R., Hsu, M., & Kayser, A. (2017). Dopamine, prefrontal cortex, and strategic learning. Society for Neuroscience Annual Meeting, Washington D.C.

Vijay, A., **Crawford, J.L.**, Seaman, K.L., Morris, E.D., & Samanez-Larkin, G.R. (2016). Decreased extrastriatal dopamine D2 receptor availability over human adulthood using [11C]-FLB457. International Symposium on Functional NeuroReceptor Mapping of the Living Brain, Boston, MA.

Crawford, J.L., Paige, L.E., Cassidy, B.S., & Gutchess, A.H. (2015). Facing the facts: Assessing the role of face-behavior incongruities in social cognition through the modulation of the N400. Social and Affective Neuroscience Society Conference, Boston, MA.

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record, Psych 3352: Biological Psychology (UT Dallas) Fall 2026
Introductory survey course on biological psychology for undergraduate students

Teaching Assistant, Psych 3604: Cognitive Neuroscience (WUSTL) Fall 2020, Spring 2021
Introductory survey course on cognitive neuroscience for undergraduate students
Lectures prepared: Motivation & Decision-Making; Executive Function; Cognitive Neuroscience of Aging

Guest Lecturer, Psych 121B: Alzheimer's Disease Resilience and Risk Factors (Brandeis) Fall 2024
Advanced seminar course on emerging topics in Alzheimer's disease research
Lecture prepared: Understanding Alzheimer's Disease Through the Lens of Daily Life

Mentoring (* denotes mentee who received external research support)

Washington University

Casey Mason [Undergraduate] 2018-2019*

Jadyn Park [Undergraduate] 2018-2020*

Jada Smith [Undergraduate] 2018-2021*

Vivian Gao [Undergraduate] 2019-2022

Janelli Rodriguez [Undergraduate] 2019-2021*

Angela Gormley [Undergraduate] 2020-2022

Brandeis University

Elizabeth Marsh [PhD rotation student] 2023

Veronica Koralewski [Post-bac research assistant] 2024

Adam Hamilton [Master's student] 2024-2025

Taylor Lazzari [PhD rotation student] 2025

Departmental & Community Service

Daily Life Methods Workshop Organizer (SRNDNA)

2025

Brandeis Aging Journal Club Organizer

2023-2026

Psychological & Brain Sciences (PBS) Aging Search Committee

2021-2022

Project SHORT (mentor)

2020-present

Psychology Graduate Student Association (PGSA) Diversity Committee

2020-2022

PBS Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Committee (student rep)

2020-2021

PBS fMRI Journal Club (co-organizer)

2018-2022

PGSA Wellness Committee

2018-2019

Reviewing

Acta Psychologica

Affective Science

Aging, Neuropsychology, and Cognition

Brain Communications

Brain Imaging and Behavior

Cell Reports

Cognitive, Affective, and Behavioral Neuroscience

Cognitive Research: Principles and Implications

Current Biology

JMIR: Mental Health

Journal of Behavior Therapy and Experimental Psychiatry

Journal of Gerontology: Psychological Sciences

Journal of Neuroscience

Memory & Cognition

Motivation & Emotion

Neurobiology of Aging

Neuroscience & Biobehavioral Reviews

Npj Aging

PNAS

Psychology and Aging

Psychophysiology

Scientific Reports

Media

Brandeis Stories <https://www.brandeis.edu/stories/2026/may/wearables-study.html>

Decision Aging & Insights Podcast (December 2024). <https://srndna.utdallas.edu/podcast/>

Professional Memberships

Alzheimer's Association International Society to Advance Alzheimer's Research and Treatment (ISTAART)

Cognitive Neuroscience Society

Gerontological Society of America

Organization for Human Brain Mapping

Society for Ambulatory Assessment

Society for Neuroeconomics

Additional Training

Intensive Longitudinal Methods Workshop	2022
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Aging & Decision Neuroscience Harmonization Workshop, SRNDNA	2019
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Cognitive, Computational, and Systems Neuroscience Training Pathway	2017-2019
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Other Skills

Programming: R, Matlab, bash/tcsh

Software: Adobe Creative Suite, AFNI, E-prime, Inquisit Lab, PMOD, Psychtoolbox, SPM (PET)